

BREATHING

◆ On average, we breathe in and out around **30,000 times a day**—exhaling enough air to inflate 3,750 party balloons.

◆ **Inhaled air** contains 20.8 percent oxygen, 0.04 percent carbon dioxide, and 79.16 percent nitrogen. Exhaled air contains 15.6 percent oxygen, 4 percent carbon dioxide, 79.16 percent nitrogen, and 1.24 percent water vapor.

◆ Every day, we swallow a large glassful of **slimy mucus**, which is produced by the airways, pushed up to the throat, and swallowed back into the esophagus.

DIGESTION

★ The salivary glands release around **4.2 pints (2 liters) of saliva** into the mouth every day.

★ The **gastric juice** released by the stomach is so acidic that it can strip paint.

★ **Tooth enamel** contains no living cells. If it is damaged, it cannot be replaced, except by fillings.

★ We have **two sets of teeth in a lifetime**: 20 baby (deciduous) teeth in childhood, which are replaced by up to 32 permanent adult teeth.

BRAIN

• The brain is about **90 percent water**.

• A new-born baby's brain weighs about **$\frac{9}{10}$ lb (375 g)** but triples in size and weight to 2.2 lb (1 kg) by the infant's first birthday.

• The brain makes up **2 percent of the body's weight** but receives 20 percent of the body's blood supply.

• Spread out, the **cerebral cortex**—the thin outer layer of the cerebrum which forms the “thinking” part of the brain—would cover the same area as a large pillow case.

• The **right side** of the brain controls the left side of the body and the left side of the brain controls the right side of the body.

• Over **250 million nerve fibers** link the left and right sides of the brain.

• Every day, adults between the ages of 20 and 60 lose about **12,000 brain neurons** that are never replaced.

• Brain neurons can last for up to **100 years**—a whole lifetime for most people.